OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION

RankAutonomous User Manual & Complete Workflow Guide

A step-by-step operational handbook for mastering autonomous SEO, AI search visibility, programmatic content publishing, and organic traffic acceleration.

Production Web Portal
https://www.rankautonomous.com

Backend API Engine
https://rankautonomous-api.onrender.com

AI Search Engine
OpenRouter Free Multi-Model Architecture

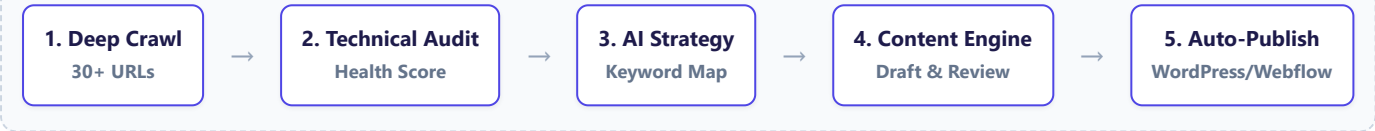
Document Version
Release 2.0 (Verified Free Inference Edition)

1. What is RankAutonomous?

RankAutonomous is an enterprise-grade, autonomous search engine optimization (SEO) and content intelligence platform designed to replace manual, tedious SEO agency workflows. By unifying deep crawling, algorithmic technical audits, semantic keyword discovery, autonomous article generation, and automated CMS publishing, RankAutonomous creates a continuous organic growth engine for your digital presence.

The Core Autonomous Loop

RankAutonomous operates on a closed-loop system that continuously moves your website from raw diagnostic data to live indexed rankings:



Key Platform Capabilities

Autonomous Content Pipeline

Generates comprehensive 1,200 to 2,000-word SEO articles with verified internal link grounding, markdown structure, and metadata — published directly to your CMS.

Zero-Cost AI Inference

Engineered to run seamlessly on verified free AI models via OpenRouter (e.g. `openrouter/free`), ensuring zero API bills, zero surprise invoices, and high-uptime fallbacks.

Anti-Hallucination Guardrails

Strict internal link validation compares every suggested hyperlinked page against real crawled URLs. The engine strictly forbids metric fabrication and spam link schemes.

Multi-Platform CMS Sync

Native adapters for WordPress REST API, Webflow Collections, Shopify, and custom REST webhooks allow one-click approvals or automated scheduled releases.

> **Guiding Principle: Evidence-Based Optimization**
>
> Unlike generic AI writers that fabricate citations and hallucinate statistics, RankAutonomous grounds every recommendation in crawl telemetry and genuine Google Search Console data.

2. Account Setup & 5-Step Onboarding

Setting up your first website takes under 5 minutes. The guided onboarding wizard captures your domain DNA to tailor every keyword recommendation, audit check, and article to your exact market.

1 Step 1: Website Profile & Localization

Navigate to `https://www.rankautonomous.com/signup`. Create your account with your work email and an 8+ character password. Upon email confirmation, you will land on the onboarding wizard:

- **Website URL:** Enter your live root domain (e.g., `https://yourcompany.com`). Validated for HTTPS and DNS reachability.
- **Business Name:** The official public brand name used in metadata and titles.
- **Industry:** Select your vertical (SaaS, E-Commerce, Professional Services, Healthcare, etc.).
- **Language & Target Country:** Configures regional search intent engines (e.g., US, UK, Global).

2 Step 2: Business Positioning & Primary Goals

Specify who you are selling to and what success means for your organic strategy:

- **Target Audience:** Define your ideal customer profile (e.g. "*B2B Engineering Directors looking for IoT hardware prototypes*").
- **SEO Goals:** Select up to 3 core goals (e.g. *Increase Organic Traffic*, *Rank for Commercial Keywords*, *Generate Inbound Leads*).
- **Geographic Scope:** Choose Global (worldwide) or Country-Specific targeting.

3 Step 3: Competitor Setup

Add 1 to 5 competitor domain URLs. RankAutonomous will crawl and analyze their content strategy, finding high-value keywords they rank for that your site is missing.

4 Step 4: Platform & CMS Selection

Select your hosting/CMS platform: **WordPress**, **Shopify**, **Webflow**, or **Custom/API**. This sets up publishing pipelines for your content calendar.

5 Step 5: Seed Keywords & Instant AI Generation

Input 3 to 10 foundational seed keywords. Click the **GENERATE AI KEYWORD SUGGESTIONS** button. The AI will instantly return 20+ commercial and transactional keywords with search intent tags and strategic rationale. Click **Finish Onboarding** to launch your workspace.

3. Website Audit & AI Strategy Engine

Once onboarding finishes, RankAutonomous immediately deploys its crawling worker to map your site architecture and evaluate on-page technical health.

The Autonomous Crawl & Technical Audit

Navigate to **Overview** (`/app`). The system executes an automated crawl of up to 100 pages, inspecting:

- **HTTP Status Codes:** 200 OK, 301/302 redirect loops, 404 broken links, and 500 server errors.
- **Title & Meta Descriptions:** Missing tags, duplicate titles, and suboptimal character lengths.
- **Content Depth:** Thin content detection (<300 words), low text-to-HTML ratio, and missing H1 tags.
- **Internal Link Topology:** Orphan pages, deep-click paths (>3 clicks from home), and broken anchor references.
- **Performance Signals:** Slow server response times, uncompressed assets, and viewport configuration.

> **Understanding Your SEO Health Score**
>
> Your site receives a composite Health Score from 0 to 100:
>
> - **90 – 100 (Optimal):** Clean architecture, indexed pages, solid link graphs.
> - **70 – 89 (Action Required):** Minor technical defects, metadata gaps, or slow pages.
> - **0 – 69 (Critical):** Broken redirects, indexing blocks, or pervasive duplicate content.

Generating Your AI SEO Strategy

On the Overview page, click **GENERATE SEO STRATEGY**. The engine merges your verified crawl data, technical audit issues, and business profile into a customized Master Strategy:

Key Strategy Deliverables

Strategy Component	Description & Actionability
Executive Summary	High-level assessment of current topical authority, traffic constraints, and fastest paths to organic ROI.
Priority Actions	Ranked list of fixes categorized into **CRITICAL**, **HIGH**, and **MEDIUM** with affected URLs.
Keyword Themes	Strategic clusters organized by intent (Commercial, Transactional, Informational) with recommended target landing pages.
Content Roadmap	Specific planned topics designed to capture immediate organic demand and build internal link clusters.
Technical Roadmap	Step-by-step developer tasks to resolve crawl errors and boost Core Web Vitals.

4. Keyword Research & Opportunity Scoring

Targeting the right keywords determines 90% of SEO success. The **Keywords** workspace (`/app/keywords`) combines search intent classification, difficulty metrics, and opportunity scoring.

Understanding Search Intent Classification

Every keyword in RankAutonomous is automatically classified into one of four search intent buckets:

Intent Type	What the Searcher Wants	Recommended Content Format
TRANSACTIONAL	Ready to buy, subscribe, or request a demo (e.g. "*buy predictive seo software*").	Product landing page, pricing page, checkout flow.
COMMERCIAL	Comparing options, reading reviews, researching vendors (e.g. "*best ai seo tools 2026*").	Comparison guides, listicles, product feature breakdowns.
INFORMATIONAL	Learning concepts, solving problems (e.g. "*how to fix crawl budget waste*").	In-depth tutorial, ultimate guide, how-to blog post.
NAVIGATIONAL	Finding a specific branded website or portal (e.g. "*rankautonomous login*").	Homepage, portal entry point, direct branded page.

The Opportunity Score Formula

Instead of guessing which keywords to write about first, RankAutonomous computes a deterministic **Opportunity Score (0 to 100)** using:

```
Opportunity Score = (Normalized Volume × 0.40) + ((100 - Difficulty) × 0.35) + (Intent Weight × 0.25)
```

High-volume, low-difficulty keywords with commercial/transactional intent score 80–100 and should be prioritized immediately.

How to Add and Manage Keywords

Three Ways to Populate Your Keyword List

1. **AI Keyword Generator:** Click "*Generate AI Keywords*" on the workspace to receive dozens of vetted search queries tailored to your industry.
2. **Manual Addition:** Type your target term, select intent, and enter estimated volume to track custom niche terms.
3. **Competitor Gaps:** Import keywords discovered during competitor analysis in the Competitor dashboard.

Pro Tip: One Click to Article

From the Keywords table, click the **"Create Article"** action next to any keyword. RankAutonomous will instantly pre-populate an article brief with that keyword set as the primary target!

5. Autonomous Content Engine & Publishing

The **Content Engine** (`/app/content`) is the core autonomous publishing machine. It transforms approved keywords into comprehensive, fully-formatted articles and schedules them to your CMS.

The 5-Stage Content Lifecycle

Stage	Status	What Happens Behind the Scenes
1. Planned	PLANNED	Article record created with title, primary keyword, target word count (e.g. 1,600), tone, and schedule date.
2. Generating	GENERATING	AI worker crafts comprehensive markdown text, headings (H2, H3), meta description, slug, and verified internal links.
3. Review Ready	REVIEW_READY	Automated quality reviewer analyzes the draft for keyword density, E-E-A-T signals, readability, and link integrity.
4. Approved	APPROVED	You or your editor review and approve the draft. Ready for automated or manual push to CMS.
5. Published	PUBLISHED	Article is published live via WordPress REST API or Webflow Collection. Immutable & locked against overwrite.

Step-by-Step: Generating Your First Article

1 Create or Select a Planned Article

In `/app/content` , click **"Plan New Article"**. Enter the topic, primary keyword, desired word count (recommended: 1,400–1,800), and tone (e.g. *Authoritative, Professional*).

2 Trigger AI Generation

Click **"Generate Article"**. The AI provider generates the full article in ~15–30 seconds. RankAutonomous inspects your crawled pages to weave natural, contextual internal links to your existing products and services.

3 Run Automated Quality Review

Click **"Run AI Review"**. The engine generates an objective Quality Score (0–100) and gives you specific suggestions on headline hooks, intro conciseness, and call-to-action clarity.

4 Approve and Publish to CMS

Review the formatted markdown in the built-in editor. When satisfied, click **"Approve"**. Then click **"Publish to CMS"** to send it live immediately, or let the Content Calendar release it on your scheduled date.

> **Publishing Safety Lock**
>
> Once an article reaches `PUBLISHED` status, RankAutonomous locks the content to prevent accidental overwrites or duplicate CMS posts.

6. CMS Connections & Google Integrations

Connecting your publishing platforms and Google analytics tools unlocks the full power of automated publishing and real-time organic rank tracking.

Connecting Your CMS (Integrations → CMS Connections)

WordPress Setup (Recommended)

RankAutonomous uses native WordPress Application Passwords for secure, zero-plugin publishing:

1. Log into your WordPress Admin dashboard (`/wp-admin`).
2. Go to **Users** → **Profile**. Scroll down to the **Application Passwords** section.
3. Enter `RankAutonomous` as the new application password name and click **Add New Application Password**.
4. Copy the generated 24-character password.
5. In RankAutonomous (`/app/integrations`), click **Add CMS Connection** → Select **WordPress**.
6. Enter your WordPress Site URL, your WordPress Admin username, and the Application Password.
7. Click **Test Connection**. When the green checkmark appears, click **Save Connection**.

Webflow Setup

1. Go to Webflow Dashboard → Project Settings → Integrations → **Generate API Token**.
2. In RankAutonomous, paste your API Token, Site ID, and target Collection ID (e.g., Blog Posts).
3. Click **Test & Save**. Articles will now publish directly into your Webflow CMS Collection!

Connecting Google Search Console & Google Analytics 4

In `/app/integrations` , click **Connect Google Search Console**:

- Authenticates securely via Google OAuth 2.0.
- Pulls verified organic impressions, clicks, average CTR, and ranking positions directly into `/app/performance` .
- Eliminates reliance on third-party rank estimation scrapers.

> **Enterprise Security & Credential Encryption**
>
> All CMS passwords and API tokens are encrypted at rest using AES-256-GCM before storage in the database. Raw tokens are never logged or exposed in client-side bundles.

7. Continuous Growth, Competitors & Reporting

SEO is a compounding game. RankAutonomous provides ongoing operational tools to keep your rankings rising week after week.

Action Plan Checklist (`/app/recommendations`)

The Action Plan transforms audit telemetry into an actionable prioritized kanban-style checklist:

- **Prioritization:** Filter by *Critical* (immediate blocker), *High Impact*, or *Quick Wins* (low effort, fast ranking boost).
- **Step-by-Step Fix Guide:** Each recommendation includes clear technical instructions (e.g. how to fix canonical tags, add missing alt text, or redirect 404s).
- **Status Tracking:** Mark tasks as *In Progress* or *Resolved*. The next crawler run will verify resolution automatically!

Competitor Intelligence (`/app/competitors`)

Monitor your rivals' organic movements:

- **Domain Authority Tracking:** Compare your domain health score and indexation breadth against your top 5 competitors.
- **Content Gap Discovery:** Identify high-ranking topics your competitors have published that you haven't covered yet.

Ethical Backlink Opportunities (`/app/backlinks`)

Strictly compliant with Google Search Essentials. RankAutonomous rejects automated spam link schemes, PBNs, and paid link farms. Instead, it identifies:

- **Digital PR & Unlinked Mentions:** High-authority publications mentioning your brand without an active hyperlink.
- **Authoritative Niche Directories:** Verified industry associations and legitimate partner resource pages.
- **Linkable Asset Ideas:** Infographics, original benchmarks, and data studies tailored to attract organic editorial citations.

Executive Monthly Reports (`/app/reports`)

Generate beautiful, presentation-ready monthly SEO summaries for founders, clients, or board members:

- Summary of articles published, words generated, and technical issues resolved.
- Net health score improvement trajectory and organic impression trends.
- One-click export to printable PDF.

8. Best Practices, Rhythm & AI Support

The Ideal Weekly SEO Rhythm

Cadence	Recommended Workflow in RankAutonomous	Estimated Time
Monday Morning	Check **Overview** (`/app`). Review new technical issues and check Performance impressions graph.	5 minutes
Wednesday	Go to **Keywords** (`/app/keywords`). Generate 10 new keyword ideas. Add 2 high-opportunity terms to the Content Engine.	10 minutes
Thursday	Open **Content Engine** (`/app/content`). Generate 2 articles, review quality scores, and approve for scheduled release.	15 minutes
End of Month	Navigate to **Reports** (`/app/reports`). Export the Monthly Executive Summary to share with stakeholders.	5 minutes

Top 5 Pro Tips for Rapid Ranking Growth

1. **Prioritize Commercial & Transactional Intent:** Don't just write informational guides. Target buyers searching with high intent for faster demo requests and sales.
2. **Publish Consistently:** Search engines reward domain freshness and topical authority. Publishing 2–3 high-quality articles per week establishes topical depth rapidly.
3. **Keep Internal Links Dense:** When publishing new articles, ensure RankAutonomous links back to your core pricing and product landing pages.
4. **Fix Critical Audit Issues Promptly:** A single 500 error or broken canonical tag on a key page can tank rankings overnight. Resolve Critical issues within 48 hours.
5. **Monitor Search Console Trends:** Check `/app/performance` bi-weekly to identify pages climbing from position 15 to 8, then optimize their titles for higher CTR.

24/7 AI Support: "Ask RankAutonomous"

Need immediate assistance while using the app? Click the floating **"Ask RankAutonomous"** support widget located at the bottom-right of every dashboard screen:

- Powered by real-time conversational AI.
- Answers questions about SEO metrics, WordPress setup, error messages, and keyword strategy.
- 100% free with unlimited chat queries.

Support & Community Resources

• **Main Portal:** https://www.rankautonomous.com
• **API Status & Health:** https://rankautonomous-api.onrender.com/health
• **Support Contact:** support@rankautonomous.com